

Figure 2.16 *Ghor Province, Male Alau, brick tower with stone base, ruin, with scroll pattern decoration. © Photograph Josephine Powell* c. *1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*

from the Da Qadi *minar* (Figure 2.17): this recent rediscovery has been put forth as possibly the early Shansabani-patronized "lost" *minar* of Qala'-yi Zarmurgh, located near Saghar, 75 km southwest of Jam-Firuzkuh.[50] Surface deterioration has been extensive on the Da Qadi tower, leaving behind no inscriptional traces and lacking the bottom bands of decoration and epigraphy horizontally framing the shafts of most twelfth-century Saljuq *minar*s. Nonetheless, its tapering cylindrical shaft, the remaining upper bands of geometric decoration, and the division of the *minar*'s shaft by means of these and likely additional bands, overall emulate the region's better-known *minar*s, such as the no longer extant one at Qasimabad in Sistan (*c.* 1125–1150 CE) (Figure 2.18) and the Daulatabad *minar* south of Balkh (early twelfth century) (Figure 2.19).[51]

Although the *minar* at Da Qadi will be analyzed in greater detail later in the chapter, it should be noted here that the ornamentation on central–southern Ghur's structures (Figures 2.13–2.16, 2.20, 2.23) differs markedly from the Da Qadi *minar* as well as the other *minar*s (Figures